

Locked into it

✦ Locke's **Social Contract**

- ✦ societally agreed upon law, not force, is the basis of govt
- ✦ **A gov't without law will be tyrannical** (this is the danger with the Hobbes view of a single ruler)
- ✦ *We give up our right to ourselves exact retribution for crimes in return for impartial justice backed by overwhelming force. We retain the right to life and liberty, and gain the right to just, impartial protection of our property*
- ✦ Locke emphasizes that the **government is appointed by the people and is therefore “responsible to them”**. This means the people hold the authority in society, the government rules with the **“consent of the governed.”**

Padlocke your door



Locke believed
the most
important right
was that to own
private property